

8.2 Ethical interviews to understand management of Water Country

Part 1: Understanding ethical research

Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples have cared for Country, including rivers, wetlands, and coastal areas, for thousands of years. Their knowledge is passed down through generations and is often sacred or culturally sensitive. When learning from Aboriginal communities, it is important to respect their knowledge and follow ethical research practices. This means:

- Always ask permission before asking questions.
- Listen carefully and do not interrupt.
- Be aware that some knowledge cannot be shared outside the community.
- Acknowledge the person and their community when using their information.

Why is ethical research important?

Part 2: Brainstorming topics

Think about what you want to learn about Water Country and Indigenous knowledge. Brainstorm your ideas below. Examples include:

- Traditional ways of caring for water
- Seasonal changes in local waterways
- Cultural significance of rivers, waterholes, or wetlands
- Environmental changes over time
- Advice for caring for Country today

Brainstorm:

Part 3: Designing questions

Create 5–10 respectful, open-ended questions you could ask an Aboriginal elder or community member to learn about the importance and management of Water Country.

	Your Question	What you hope to learn from this Question
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		

Reflection

How could listening to Aboriginal voices help manage water sustainably today?
